

Module 08: Planning — The Bedtime Routine

Learning Objectives

1. Understand that **Planning** is a list of steps to reach a goal.
2. Learn about **Algorithms** (A fancy word for a Routine).
3. Know that routines help our brains feel safe and ready to sleep.

Introduction: The Sleepy Train

Imagine a train going to Sleepy Town. It has to make stops:

1. Bath Station.
2. Pajama Junction.
3. Storybook Corner.
4. Sleepy Town! If the train skips a stop, the passengers (your brain cells) get confused! A Routine is a map for the train.

Key Concepts

1. The Algorithm (The Recipe)

Computers follow algorithms.

- Input: Dirty Kid.
- Step 1: Wash with soap.
- Step 2: Dry with towel.
- Step 3: Put on clean PJs.
- Output: Clean, Cozy Kid. Bedtime is an algorithm!

2. Predictability (Safety)

Your brain loves to predict the future. When you know what comes next (After bath implies books), your brain relaxes. "Ah, I know this pattern. It is time to wind down." Chaos (Unpredictability) keeps the brain awake/alert.

3. The Goal (Recharge)

Why do we do this? Because sleep is when the brain fixes itself and grows. The Plan leads to the Goal: A full battery for tomorrow.

Activities

Activity 1: The Picture Schedule

Draw pictures of your bedtime steps (Toothbrush, Book, Pillow). Tape them to the wall in order. Tonight, follow the map! "Check! We brushed teeth. Next stop: Pajamas."

Activity 2: Robot Bedtime

Pretend to be a robot that needs to power down. "Initiating Sleep Sequence." "Powering down arms... (Relax arms)." "Powering down legs... (Relax legs)." "Shutting down optical sensors... (Close eyes)." "System Hibernate."

Summary

Planning isn't boring; it's a superpower. By following a routine, we help our brains predict the future and get the rest we need to grow big and strong.

References

- *Goodnight Moon* by Margaret Wise Brown
- *The Going to Bed Book* by Sandra Boynton